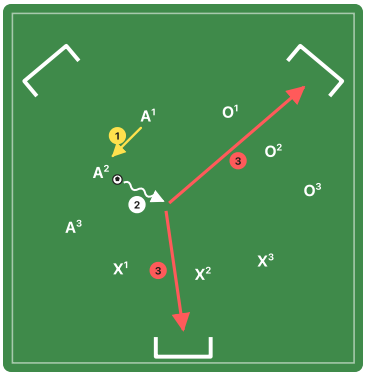
PHS Varsity - Practice Plan

Focus: Small-sided play, transition and finishing; PK rotation for districts

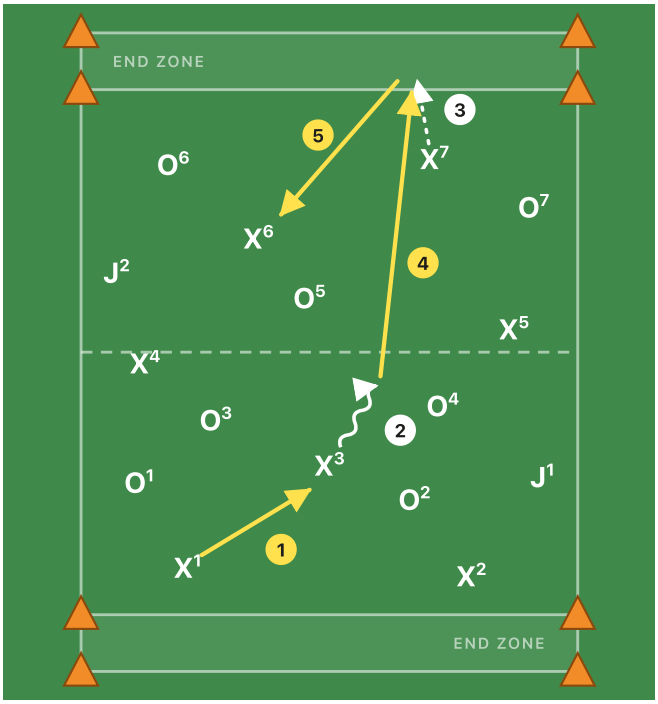


1. 3v3v3 Three Goals

Time: _____ min

Setup. Three goals in a triangle: two near the top corners, angled toward the middle, and one centered at the bottom. Three teams of three: A1, A2 and A3 guard the top-left goal, O1, O2 and O3 guard the top-right goal, and X1, X2 and X3 guard the bottom goal. Each team defends its own goal and can score on either of the other two. Play one of three formats: 90-second games, first to 3 goals, or every time a team is scored on it loses a player.

1. A1 passes to A2.
2. A2 dribbles into the middle.
3. A2 shoots on the O goal or the X goal.



2. Scan Split Score

Time: _____ min

Setup. A 45x35 yard field in the middle third with a 4-yard end zone across each end, marked with cones. Xs attack the top end zone and Os attack the bottom. Seven Xs, seven Os, and two jokers (J1, J2) who play with whichever team has the ball, so the team in possession is always 9v7. Jokers can't score or enter an end zone. The GKs work separately. A point is a completed pass to a teammate who checks into the end zone and lays it back. It's 2 points if the entry pass is first-time or comes right after a directional first touch. Rounds are 4 minutes or first to 5 points, with 60 seconds between rounds. Play 3 rounds and swap the jokers each round. A ball out of play restarts with the other team from their own end zone. Progression: 2-touch max.

1. X1 passes to X3.
2. X3 takes a directional first touch forward into space.
3. X7 checks into the end zone.
4. X3 passes to X7 in the end zone, between O5 and O7.
5. X7 passes back to X6. The entry came off a directional first touch, so it scores 2 points.

Coaching points

Check your shoulder before the ball arrives. / Have two options before you receive. Decide before the ball gets there. / Open your hips toward where your first touch is going. / First touch out of your feet and into space. / Pass and move. / Watch the weight of the pass, not just the direction. / Be decisive. Fast and wrong beats slow and perfect.



3. Build Out to Target

Time: _____ min

Setup. Ball starts with Keeper. Xs build out of the back trying to get the ball to T (target) at the top of the grid. Os lay defense. If Os win the ball, they immediately counter on goal. If Xs get to T, then play quickly shifts and T plays to Os for a counter attack. X quickly reshapes into defensive structure. After every shot or ball out of play, the GK restarts by passing to the Xs. Offside applies when the Os attack the big goal, with the offside line at the edge of the 18.

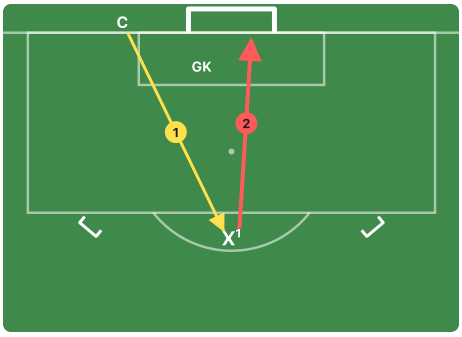
1. The GK passes to X3.
2. X3 passes to T, past O1, O2 and O3.
3. T passes to O1. Direction changes as soon as T receives.
4. O1 shoots on the big goal.

Cone Pass Movement Dribble Shot Spin

4. Rapid Fire 3v2

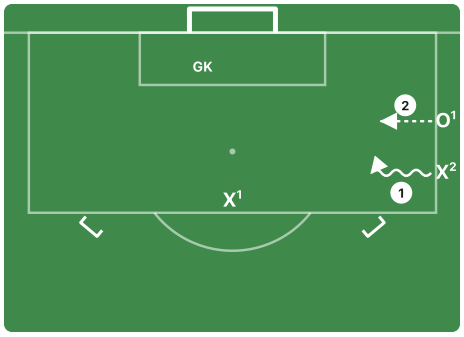
Time: _____ min

Setup. The area around the 18: the goal with a GK, the 6-yard box, the 18 line and the penalty arc. The drill boundary runs just outside the mini goals. Two mini goals, about a quarter the size of the main goal, sit just outside the 18 on either side of the penalty arc, angled toward the goal. A server (coach or player) with balls beside the goal. X1 starts inside the penalty arc above the 18. X2 and O1 wait off one side of the 18, between the mini goal and the end line, X3 and O2 off the other side, each pair with a ball. Three stages run back to back with no stoppage; the moment a ball is out of play or the GK has it, the next pair enters.



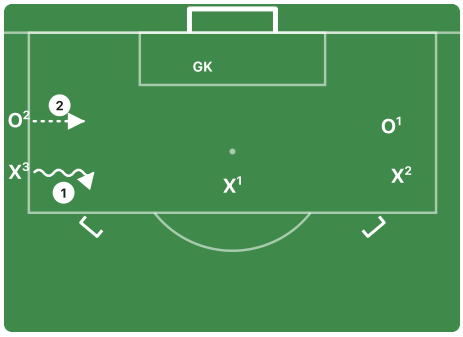
Part 1: pass and shoot

1. The server passes to X1 inside the penalty arc.
2. X1 shoots from the arc. If the ball stays in play, X1 goes for the rebound. When the ball is out of play or the GK has it, Part 2 starts.



Part 2: 2v1

1. X2 dribbles into the 18 from the side, between the mini goal and the end line, with the second ball.
2. O1 enters beside X2 and defends.
3. X1 and X2 attack 2v1 and shoot. If O1 wins the ball, O1 scores on a mini goal. When the ball is out of play or the GK has it, Part 3 starts.

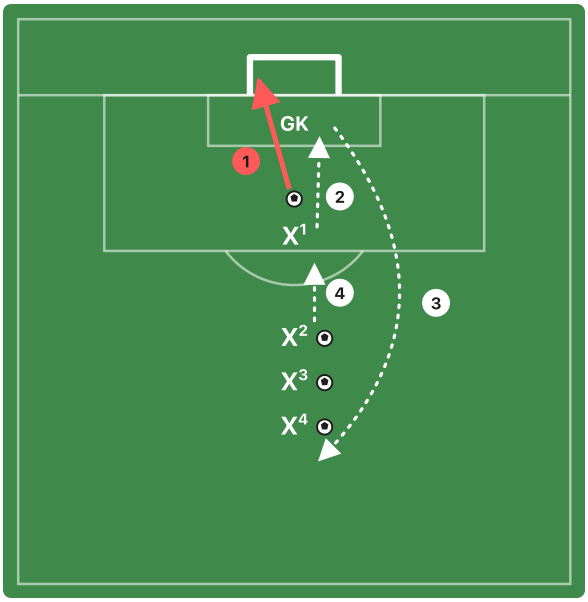


Part 3: 3v2

1. X3 dribbles into the 18 from the other side, between the mini goal and the end line, with the third ball.
2. O2 enters beside X3 and defends.
3. X1, X2 and X3 attack 3v2 and shoot. If the Os win the ball, they score on a mini goal. When the ball is out of play or the GK has it, the rep ends and the next group starts Part 1.

Coaching points

Keep it rapid: the next pair enters the moment the ball is out of play or the GK has it. / Xs chase every rebound that stays in play. / Os who win the ball go straight to a mini goal; the Xs must recover and defend.



5. Speed Ks

Time: _____ min

Setup. Goal with a GK and a ball on the penalty spot. The rest of the team lines up behind the spot, outside the 18, each with a ball. The diagram shows X1 on the spot and X2, X3 and X4 in line.

1. X1 shoots from the penalty spot.
2. X1 runs to the goal and becomes the GK.
3. The GK rotates to the back of the line.
4. X2 places a ball on the spot and shoots as soon as X1 is set in goal.

Coaching points

Keep the line moving. The goal is as many PKs per player as possible. / Track each player's makes to help set the PK order.

Cone Pass Movement Dribble Shot Spin